Kevin Trayner

609-532-8328 | kevinctrayner@gmail.com | Hamilton, NJ 08690 | LinkedIn Portfolio

Overview

Product & Strategic Design Leader with 20+ years driving experience vision and customer-centric strategies, translating complex business problems into seamless digital products that scale to 150M+ users. Expert at bridging CX, product, and executive stakeholders to reduce friction, accelerate time-to-market, and build products grounded in understanding and research.

Skills

- **Design & Strategy:** Product Design | Experience Architecture | Content Strategy | Research and Analysis | Design Systems and Governance | Journey Mapping.
- **Leadership & Execution:** Cross-Functional Team Leadership | Agile/SDLC | Friction Audits | Stakeholder Alignment | Design Mentorship.
- **Tools & Artifacts:** Wireframing & Prototyping | Figma Component Libraries | Generative AI for UX (Gemini | Claude Code | Copilot).

Relevant Work Experience

- **Use research, prototyping, early testing and iteration to incrementally improve, then revamp our mobile plans architecture.** *Case Study: Redesign our core mobile plans architecture from early concept through to delivery*.
- **Create the end-to-end vision, and remove ambiguity to create delightful experiences for our users.** *Case Study: Netflix and Max. Own and define the end-to-end experience, and remove ambiguity for a new streaming launch*.
- **Use storytelling and research to build consensus among stakeholders and validate design decisions with target audiences.** *Case Study: Create a design strategy and journey map for a new Satellite service*.
- **Collaborate cross functionally with product and development stakeholders to align product strategy and translate complexity into simple experiences.** *Case Study: Build an end to end experience across channels, functions and business units for FCC labels*.
- **Champion design craft, and design system/accessibility governance:** Mentor junior designers, meet weekly with the Verizon Design System team to identify and build forward-looking patterns, and identify opportunities with our Accessibility team; all to continually elevate organizational standards.
- **Rooted in editorial, content strategy and community service:** Managed editorial content for local community newspapers and oversaw the startup of a new publication. At Verizon, I helped create the first content management for plans content (used across multiple systems). On the board of Murray Grove Retreat center serving the Lacey township and the greater Unitarian Universalist community.

Experience

Verizon Consumer Group (VCG) - Basking Ridge, NJ

Lead design strategist for mobile and related digital products for a 150 million customer base.

Principal Experience Designer / Architect (2024 – Present)

- **Define Experience Vision:** Lead end-to-end design strategy for mobile products, identify and close experience architecture conflicts and gaps, and untangle complex problems into simple digital journeys for customers. As part of that effort, helped standardize, build and maintain the core content repository for plans content used across channels and products.
- **Refine and redesign our mobile plans architecture:** Address current friction points in our mobile plans today, and create a vision to distinguish Verizon from the competition with myPlans, by simplifying customer choice and encouraging higher-value plans. The myPlans mobile plan launch saw around 13 million subscribers after its initial rollout, and is used by more than half of our 150 million wireless customers.
- **Design system & process governance:** Created reusable Figma templates and guidance to help launch new promotions faster. Met weekly with Verizon Design System (VDS) team to identify and build forward-looking patterns, work with the accessibility team to ensure compliance in our VDS patterns.
- **Cross-functional alignment & stakeholder leadership:** Led collaborative workshops with business, product, and design leaders to solve technical issues and align cross-channel strategies.
- **Mentorship & practice development:** Mentored junior and mid-level designers on design skills, system thinking, and presentations, and led design critiques to continually elevate team standards and improve our ways of working.

Lead Experience Designer (2021 – 2024)

- **Reduce friction/improve experience for mobile sales, increasing revenue:** Worked with our CX director to reduce friction and increase conversion for our add a line experience, contributing to $8.4M/mo in revenue (and was recognized with a GOAT award).
- **Own end-to-end experience for new streaming launch:** Launched a new streaming combo service (Netflix/Max) that fit the existing service model, satisfied our partners, and removed ambiguity for customers. Remains Verizon's second-best-selling perk, on nearly 11 million mobile accounts.
- **Modernized product experience to increase sales:** Led CX updates for connected device plans (tablets and smartwatches), directly contributing to tablet premium plan activations performing 3.3% above forecast.
- **Partner with business, developers, designers, CX, and legal from high level vision to detail design experience across multiple channels, products and teams:** Led the UX design and cross-platform implementation for FCC-mandated product labels across all mobile and home services across the entire Verizon ecosystem, meeting legal requirements without negatively impacting the plans experience.

Senior UX Designer (2016 – 2021)

- Optimized the Learn & Buy sales funnel on Verizon.com, enhancing web and mobile journeys for 115M users.
- Delivered high-fidelity wireframes, interactive prototypes, and user flows in close collaboration with development and brand teams.

Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu - Princeton, NJ

Envision, deliver and support products used by 80,000 client service professionals in 32 countries to

perform their daily work on audit engagements - a $20 billion revenue stream today.

Senior Business Analyst/Designer (2010 – 2016)

- Created and managed user requirements and experience design for internal software used by 80,000 professionals across 32 countries.
- Validated experiences through surveys, interviews, and regular UAT and usability testing with real users from across the globe.
- Delivered both desktop and web applications from high level concept to wireframe, including personas, styles, controls, navigation, site maps, page flows, and prototypes.

User Experience Designer (2004 – 2010)

- Designed enterprise web/desktop applications, delivering wireframes, process flows, site maps, and UI pattern libraries.
- Wrote comprehensive user guides and support materials to help employees worldwide adopt new software.

Multimedia Specialist (2001 – 2004)

- Developed interactive product demos and visual prototypes to support global software rollouts.

Technical Writer (1995 – 2001)

- Authored user documentation and help guides for desktop applications serving 20,000 global users.

Additional Experience

Instructional Designer - Eduneering
Designed interactive computer-based training modules for Fortune 500 clients in the energy and telecommunications industries for small, start up tech consulting firm. (Owned by UL Solutions today).

Editor - Cranbury Publications
Managed production, design, and writing staff for local newspapers and oversaw the startup of a new publication.

Education and Certifications

• **Google AI Professional Certificate** — Coursera / Google (2026).
• **BA in English / Communications** — Ursinus College, Collegeville, PA.

Leadership and Publications

• **Board of Trustees** — Murray Grove Retreat Center, Lanoka Harbor, NJ. Provide oversight, strategic direction, and governance for a 20 acre retreat focused on radical hospitality.
• **Published Author & Columnist** — Author of *Beer Drinker's Handbook* | Columnist for Ale Street News.